

The JACL Author's Guide

Seventh Edition

JACL is a programming language for writing interactive fiction — the kind of text adventure where the player types commands and reads what happens next.

This book is the reference for authors. It walks through writing a complete game from scratch, then takes a chapter-by-chapter tour of every language feature: objects, locations, attributes, grammar, flow control, the standard library of verbs, the menu system, the web interface, multimedia, and the JACL-to-HTML pipeline used by the **cgijacl** and **fcgijacl** interpreters.

Three appendices give the complete attribute table, the full set of 216 library verbs, and the source code for the tutorial game.

Stuart Allen

JACL Interpreter v4.7 · copyright 1992–2026 Stuart Allen

github.com/DangarStu/JACL · dangarstu@gmail.com

Distributed under the GNU General Public License, version 2 or later.

```
location bedroom : master bedroom
west             bathroom
south            nowhere

look
print:
  You are in your bedroom. There is
  a large, soft bed in the centre
  of the room while a doorway to the
  west leads into the bathroom.
  -
  write "To the south there is "
  if door has CLOSED
    write "closed"
  else
    write "open"
  endif
  write " door.^\n"
}

movement
if compass = south
  if destination = nowhere
    write "The bedroom door
    is closed.^\n"
    return true
  endif
endif
return false

object bed: bed
short      a "bed"
mass       scenery

look_under
if guide(parent) = limbo
  write "Hidden under the bed you
  find this week's television guide.^\n"
  set guide(parent) = here
  points 50
  return
endif
write "You don't find anything else.^\n"

object guide: television tv tele guide
short      a "television guide"
long       "The television guide
is here.^\n"
parent     limbo
mass       5
```

JACL

ADVENTURE CREATION LANGUAGE

Author's Guide

THE DEFINITIVE GUIDE TO WRITING
INTERACTIVE FICTION WITH JACL



POWERFUL SCRIPTING

A flexible, expressive
language for all
types of adventures.



IMMERSIVE WORLDS

Bring your stories
to life with rich
locations, objects
and logic.



BUILD ANYTHING

From simple tales
to complex, branching
epics.



COMPLETE REFERENCE

Everything you need
to master JACL.